

Welcome to PicOrg

PicOrg is a fast, local, native photo-organiser for Windows (with future macOS support). It lets you pull one or more folders of images into a searchable library, tag and rate them, and organise them by metadata — all without uploading a single byte to the cloud.

This manual walks you through everything you need to get productive with PicOrg in an afternoon. If you’re a developer looking for how the pieces fit together, see the companion **PicOrg Developer Guide**.

What PicOrg is (and isn’t)

PicOrg is	PicOrg is not
A metadata-first organiser: tags, ratings, titles, comments	A photo editor (no crop, no retouch, no filters)
A fast local viewer for large libraries (hundreds of thousands)	A cloud service — no account, no upload, no telemetry
Interoperable: writes standard XMP that Lightroom & Explorer read	A DAM with keyword hierarchies or face recognition (yet)
Free and open-source	A RAW developer

Two-minute tour

1. **Add a folder** — Click **Add folder** in the top bar and pick a directory of images. PicOrg indexes it (scanning happens in parallel and updates the grid live).
2. **Browse** — Scroll through the virtualised grid on the left. Use the sidebar to filter by rating, tag, or folder.
3. **Edit** — Click any photo to open the details panel on the right. Type a title, click a star for a rating, add tags. Everything saves automatically.
4. **Multi-select** — Ctrl-click (Windows) to select multiple photos. The details panel switches to a batch view; add or remove tags, set a rating, or delete in bulk.
5. **Find** — Type in the search bar to filter across titles, comments, filenames, and tags.

That’s it. The rest of this manual is optional deep-diving.

Where things live at a glance

- **Your photos:** exactly where you put them. PicOrg never moves them.
- **Your metadata:**
 - Saved into an XMP **sidecar** file next to each photo (`Photo.jpg` → `Photo.xmp`), and
 - **Embedded inside the source JPEG** so tools like Windows Explorer, the Photos app, Adobe Lightroom, and digiKam see the same tags.
- **The PicOrg index:** a single SQLite database plus a thumbnail cache under `%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg\` — deleting that folder resets the app but never touches your photos.

The [Where your data lives](#) chapter has the full story if you want to know exactly what changes.

Installing and launching PicOrg

System requirements

- **Operating system:** Windows 10 (build 19041) or newer, or Windows 11. Requires the Microsoft Edge WebView2 runtime, which is pre-installed on Windows 11 and delivered automatically by Windows Update on Windows 10.
- **Disk:** ~50 MB for the app itself, plus roughly **8 KB per thumbnail** (two sizes per photo) in the cache. A 50 000-photo library uses ~400 MB of thumbnails.
- **Memory:** 200 MB idle; scales with library size and grid density.

Installing

Grab the latest release from your usual distribution channel (installer `.msi`, portable `.exe`, or self-built from source), then double-click to launch. PicOrg is a single-window app — no service to start, no account to create.

Note. PicOrg does not need administrator privileges. If Windows prompts you for elevation, that means you're installing a signed MSI — say “yes” once, then run the app as your normal user.

First launch

The first time you run PicOrg it creates:

- The library database at `%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg\picorg.db`.
- An empty thumbnail cache at `%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg\thumbs\`.
- A log file at `%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg\logs\picorg.log`.

The main window opens on **All photos** with a helpful “Add folder” prompt. See the next chapter to add your first folder.

Where your library data lives

What	Path
Library database	%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg\picorg.db
Thumbnail cache	%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg\thumbs\
Log file	%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg\logs\picorg.log
Your photos	Wherever you put them — PicOrg never moves them
Sidecar .xmp files	Next to each photo (Photo.jpg → Photo.xmp)
Embedded XMP (JPEG only, v1)	Inside the JPEG APP1 segment of the source file

Uninstalling

Delete %APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg\ to wipe the library index and cache. That resets PicOrg completely but leaves every photo and every sidecar .xmp on disk exactly as it was.

Adding your first folder

PicOrg organises photos around **library folders**. A library folder is just any directory on your disk that you'd like PicOrg to keep an eye on — the app scans it recursively and shows every image it finds in the grid.

Adding a folder

1. Click **+ Add folder** in the top bar.
2. Pick a folder in the system dialog. Windows OneDrive folders, network shares, and long-path (\\?\\) paths are all supported.
3. Scanning starts immediately. The status bar at the bottom shows **Scanning N photos...** and updates in real time.

The grid populates as PicOrg discovers files: you can start browsing and editing before the scan is finished.

What “scanning” actually does

For every image file, PicOrg:

1. Records its full path, size, modification time, and format.
2. Reads embedded EXIF for taken-at time, camera make/model, and image dimensions.
3. Reads XMP (from the sidecar **.xmp** **or** from an APP1 segment inside the JPEG itself) for title, rating, tags, and comment.
4. Generates two thumbnail sizes (small and medium) into the cache.
5. Computes a content hash so PicOrg can detect duplicates and renames later.

Scanning uses all your CPU cores and is bounded by disk read speed. A first-time scan of 10 000 photos on an SSD takes a couple of minutes; subsequent rescans are near-instant because PicOrg only re-processes files whose modification time has changed.

Adding more folders

You can add as many library folders as you like. They all show up under **Library › Folders** in the sidebar. Click a folder name to filter the grid to just its photos.

Removing a folder

Right-click a folder in the sidebar and choose **Remove from library**. This removes it from the PicOrg index and deletes the corresponding thumbnails. **Your photos and sidecar `.xmp` files are untouched.**

Rescanning

Photos added to a library folder outside of PicOrg (say, you dropped new files in with File Explorer) aren't discovered automatically. Two ways to fix that:

- **Right-click a folder** → **Rescan** to rescan just that folder.
- **Click Rescan in the top bar** to rescan every folder in the library.

Rescans are incremental and safe: PicOrg only touches files that have changed, are new, or have disappeared.

Browsing your library

The centre of the PicOrg window is a **virtualised image grid**. It can scroll through hundreds of thousands of photos without slowing down — only the tiles visible in the viewport are actually drawn.

The grid

Each tile shows a thumbnail plus the filename and pixel dimensions. Hover a tile to see the full path in a tooltip; click to open the photo in the details panel on the right.

- **Click** — select a photo (replaces any previous selection).
- **Ctrl+click** — add/remove a photo from the current selection.
- **Shift+click** — select a range from the last-clicked photo to the clicked one.
- **Double-click** — (reserved for future full-screen preview.)
- **Delete key** — move the current selection to the Recycle Bin, after a confirmation prompt.

The count in the top-left of the grid header (`152 images`) is the number of photos that match the current filter, not necessarily the whole library.

Sorting

The **Sort** control at the top-right of the grid controls the order:

- **Taken** — by the date the photo was captured (from EXIF `DateTimeOriginal`). Missing dates fall to the end.
- **Modified** — by file system modification time.
- **Filename** — alphabetical.
- **Rating** — 5 stars first, unrated last.
- **Random** — a shuffled order that stays stable while the filter doesn't change.

Toggle the arrow next to the sort control to flip between ascending and descending.

The details panel

The right-hand pane shows details for the currently selected photo (or photos, if more than one is selected). When nothing is selected, it prompts you to pick something.

You can hide the details panel via the icon in the top-right corner to give the grid more room. Toggle it back on from the same spot.

Sidebar filters

The sidebar on the left has three sections that all act as filters:

1. **Library › Folders** — click a folder to filter to just its photos.
2. **Rating** — click a rating threshold to show photos with **that many stars or more**. So clicking “3 stars and up” shows 3-, 4-, and 5-star photos.
3. **Tags** — click a tag to filter to only photos with that tag. Numbers on the right show how many photos are in each tag.

Filters compose: click a folder **and** a rating **and** a tag and you’ll see only photos matching all three. Combine with the search box for arbitrarily narrow queries.

Clearing filters

Click **All photos** at the top of the sidebar to reset every filter in one shot.

Searching and filtering

Full-text search

The search box at the top of the window filters the grid live as you type. PicOrg uses SQLite's FTS5 (full-text search) engine over four fields:

- `title`
- `comment`
- `filename` (including the extension)
- `tags`

The default matching is **prefix-friendly** and case-insensitive, so typing `sun` finds photos titled *Sunset*, tagged `sunny`, in a file called `sunbathing.jpg`, or with a comment mentioning "sunrise".

Boolean operators

Because FTS5 is under the hood, you can also write more elaborate queries:

- `vacation beach` — photos matching both terms (AND is implicit).
- `vacation OR beach` — photos matching either.
- `vacation -beach` — vacation photos that are not tagged beach.
- `"family reunion"` — exact phrase.
- `tag:2024` — restrict to a specific column (advanced).

Diacritics

The tokenizer strips diacritics, so `naïve` matches `naïve` and vice versa.

Combining search with sidebar filters

Search and sidebar filters compose with AND. For example, showing "5-star photos from `\Photos\Trips\Iceland` tagged `aurora` mentioning `glacier`" is:

1. Click the Iceland folder in the sidebar.
2. Click **5 stars and up** in the sidebar.
3. Click the `aurora` tag in the sidebar.
4. Type `glacier` in the search box.

The status bar at the bottom always shows the count of images matching your current combined filter.

Clearing the search

Click the `×` inside the search box (or press `Esc` while focused there) to clear the query. Sidebar filters aren't touched.

Search performance

FTS5 is fast. On a 250 000-photo library, a query typically returns results in a few milliseconds. If a query ever feels slow, it's usually because a big filter change is invalidating cached thumbnails being redrawn — the query itself finishes long before the grid.

Editing metadata

Select a single photo in the grid to open the **Details** panel on the right. It shows every editable field along with read-only information about the file itself.

Editable fields

Field	Standard XMP mapping	Notes
Title	<code>dc:title</code> / <code>xmp:Title</code>	Free-form text, single line.
Rating	<code>xmp:Rating</code> (0–5)	0 = “not rated”. Click a star to set.
Tags	<code>dc:subject</code> + <code>MicrosoftPhoto:LastKeywordXMP</code>	Space, comma, or Enter commits a new tag.
Comment	<code>dc:description</code> / <code>xmp:Description</code>	Free-form text, multi-line.

Auto-save

PicOrg saves automatically as you type. There is no explicit “Save” button:

- **Title and comment** save 600 ms after your last keystroke (or immediately if you Tab away from the field). The details panel title briefly reads `Saving title...` while it’s happening.
- **Rating and tags** save the moment you commit the change (click a star, or press Space/Enter after a tag).

Every save writes to **two** places:

1. The `.xmp` sidecar next to the photo.
2. The **embedded XMP** inside the source JPEG itself.

So a title you type in PicOrg shows up in Windows Explorer’s Details tab and in Lightroom without any further action.

Clearing a field

- **Title / Comment:** delete the text and Tab out (or wait for the auto-save).
- **Rating:** click the current star again to reset back to “not rated”.
- **Tags:** hover a tag pill and click the  that appears; that tag is removed immediately.

Tag input specifics

The tag input has one job — accepting strings — but the small details matter:

- Type a tag, then press **Space**, **Comma**, or **Enter** to commit it into a chip.
- Clicking elsewhere (blurring the input) also commits any pending draft; you won’t lose a typed tag by clicking Save-adjacent buttons.
- Autocompletion suggests existing tags in your library while you type. Use the arrow keys and Enter to pick one.
- Backspace on an empty input deletes the last committed tag.
- Tags are case-insensitive: adding `Beach` to a photo that already has `beach` is a no-op.

Read-only info

The **File info** block underneath the editable fields shows:

- Pixel dimensions.
- File size in a human-readable unit.
- Taken time (from EXIF `DateTimeOriginal`).
- Modified time (from the file system).
- Camera make and model (from EXIF).
- Format (JPEG, PNG, HEIC, RAW, ...).
- **Metadata saved** — the last time PicOrg wrote XMP for this photo.

The path is displayed above the file info; click it to select and copy the full string to your clipboard.

Working on many photos at once

Selecting more than one photo switches the details panel into **batch mode**. The title bar shows **N images selected** and the editable controls change to reflect what makes sense to apply in bulk.

Selecting multiple photos

- **Ctrl+click** — toggle a photo in the current selection.
- **Shift+click** — extend the selection from the last-clicked photo to the new one.
- **Ctrl+A** — select everything currently visible in the grid.
- Click a photo without a modifier to reset the selection back to a single photo.

The selection persists as you scroll, so you can Ctrl+click a photo near the top, scroll down thousands of pictures, and Shift+click one at the bottom to grab a huge range.

Bulk rating

Click a star in the **Set rating** control. That rating is applied to every selected photo immediately — no confirmation.

Use rating  (the leftmost, empty-star click) to un-rate everything in the selection.

Bulk tag add / remove

The batch view has two tag inputs instead of one:

- **Add tags** — every tag you commit here is added to every selected photo, without touching any tags they already have.
- **Remove tags** — every tag you commit here is removed from every selected photo (photos that didn't have the tag are unaffected).

Both fields let you queue up multiple tags before hitting the button. When you're ready, click **Apply tag changes to N images**. The button label counts down as it saves and shows a green *"Updated N images"* confirmation when done.

Tip. In multi-select mode PicOrg doesn't show you the union of tags already on the selection — it would be misleading (some photos would have that tag, some wouldn't). Use single-select for that.

Bulk delete

Click **Delete N images** at the bottom of the details panel to move the whole selection to the Recycle Bin. A confirmation dialog appears first — see the [Deleting photos](#) chapter for details.

What actually happens in bulk

Every bulk operation is applied **photo by photo** on the backend. If one photo fails (say, its source folder is read-only) the others still succeed. When there are failures, PicOrg summarises them in a dialog after the run.

Tags: adding, renaming, cleaning up

Tags are the primary organisational tool in PicOrg. They are simple, flat strings — no hierarchy, no groups. Tag a photo `family`, `2024`, and `beach`, and later ask for “everything tagged `beach` and `2024`” in a couple of clicks.

The tag sidebar

Every tag in your library is listed under **Tags** in the sidebar, with a count of how many photos carry it. The list is sorted alphabetically.

- **Click a tag** to filter the grid to only photos with that tag.
- **Right-click** for tag maintenance:
 - **Rename tag...** — updates every photo carrying that tag, including their XMP sidecars and embedded XMP.
 - **Delete tag** — removes the tag from every photo, but does not delete any files.

Adding tags

The [Editing metadata](#) and [Working on many photos at once](#) chapters cover the two main entry points. In both cases:

- **Space** or **Enter** commits the current typed word as a tag.
- **Comma** commits it too (useful if you’re pasting a comma-separated list).
- **Backspace** on an empty input deletes the last committed tag.
- Tags are case-insensitive. `Beach` and `beach` are the same tag.

Autocompletion

While typing a tag, PicOrg shows a dropdown with tags already in your library that match your prefix. Use `↑`/`↓` to select and `Enter` to accept — that keeps naming consistent across your library.

Tag persistence

When you save a tag, PicOrg writes it to:

1. The photo's `.xmp` sidecar (`Photo.jpg` → `Photo.xmp`).
2. The photo's embedded XMP inside the JPEG itself (for JPEG sources).

That means:

- Windows Explorer's *Details* → *Tags* column shows PicOrg's tags.
- Adobe Lightroom, Bridge, and digiKam read PicOrg's tags and vice-versa.
- Files remain valid JPEG/PNG/etc — no format-level surprises.

Renaming tags safely

Right-click **Tags** › `old-name` → **Rename tag...** PicOrg:

1. Updates every affected photo's XMP.
2. Rewrites the FTS search index so search finds the new spelling.
3. Refreshes the sidebar counts.

All in a single transaction — either the whole rename succeeds or none of it does.

Deleting a tag globally

Right-click a tag → **Delete tag** removes the tag from every photo in the library. This is not the same as deleting photos — the files stay put, they just lose the tag.

A note on Windows Explorer tags

Windows Explorer stores tags in a Windows-specific `LastKeywordXMP` field alongside the standard `dc:subject`. PicOrg reads **both**, so tags added in Explorer show up in PicOrg. Tags added in PicOrg go into both fields, so they show up in Explorer too.

Star ratings

PicOrg uses the standard XMP rating scale — an integer from 0 to 5 — stored as `xmp:Rating` inside the photo's XMP.

Setting a rating

The **Rating** row in the details panel shows five stars. Click the star at the level you want. Clicking star 3, for example, sets the rating to 3 and highlights stars 1–3.

- **Click the same star again** to clear the rating back to “not rated”.
- Rating changes save immediately, both to the sidecar and into the source file's embedded XMP.

Filtering by rating

The **Rating** section of the sidebar lists five thresholds:

- **5 stars** — show only 5-star photos.
- **4 stars and up** — 4 and 5.
- **3 stars and up** — 3, 4, and 5.
- **2 stars and up** — 2, 3, 4, and 5.
- **1 star and up** — everything with any rating (excludes unrated).

Click a threshold to apply it as a filter. Click **All photos** at the top of the sidebar (or the same threshold again) to clear.

Batch rating

Select multiple photos, then click a star in the **Set rating** control in the details panel. Every selected photo gets that rating in one shot. This is the fastest way to sweep through a shoot and promote your keepers.

Interoperability

`xmp:Rating` is the industry-standard XMP rating field:

- **Adobe Lightroom** reads and writes the same field. Import a PicOrg-rated folder into Lightroom and every rating is there.
- **Adobe Bridge** shows the ratings.
- **Windows Photos app** uses the same field for its star rating.
- **digiKam, XnView, FastStone, IrfanView** all recognise it.

If a photo already had a rating in another tool, PicOrg reads it on first scan; when you edit it in PicOrg, the change flows back through the sidecar and embedded XMP to the other tool the next time it refreshes its index.

Deleting photos

PicOrg has one deletion path with two safety layers: an explicit confirmation prompt, and Recycle-Bin-by-default (so mistakes are recoverable).

Deleting a single photo

Select the photo, then either:

- Click the red **Delete image** button at the bottom of the details panel, or
- Press `Delete` on the keyboard.

A confirmation dialog appears:

Move "IMG_2043.jpg" to the Recycle Bin? You can restore it from the Windows Recycle Bin afterwards.

Click **Move to Recycle Bin** to proceed, or **Cancel** to back out.

Deleting many photos

Multi-select as usual (Ctrl+click, Shift+click) and click **Delete N images** at the bottom of the details panel. The confirmation dialog reads *"Move N images to the Recycle Bin?"*.

What PicOrg actually does

On confirmation, for every selected photo, PicOrg:

1. Moves the source file to the **Windows Recycle Bin** using the OS API (the same code path Explorer uses).
2. Moves the sidcar `.xmp` file (if any) to the Recycle Bin too.
3. Removes the photo from the library database.
4. Deletes any cached thumbnails.

If a step fails (e.g. Windows refuses to move a locked file), PicOrg does *not* remove the photo from the index — better to have a dead row you can retry than lose track of a real file.

Recovering a deleted photo

Open the Windows Recycle Bin, right-click the file, choose **Restore**. It goes back where it was. On the next PicOrg **Rescan** the photo reappears in the library with the same tags, rating, and title it had before (they were preserved in the sidecar).

Permanently deleting

If you're absolutely sure, hold **Shift** when clicking Delete (or Shift+Delete on the keyboard). PicOrg then bypasses the Recycle Bin and deletes the file directly. The confirmation prompt is worded differently in that mode so you know you're skipping the safety net.

Warning. Shift-delete cannot be undone. If in doubt, use the normal delete and empty the Recycle Bin later.

What is NOT deleted

- Photos in **library folders you removed** are not touched — removing a library folder only removes the index entries.
- Tags “belong to the library”; even if you delete every photo that had a tag, the tag itself lingers in the sidebar with a count of 0 until you right-click it → Delete tag.

Where your data lives

PicOrg is a **local, transparent** photo manager. Everything it stores is either standard XMP (in your photos and next to them) or a cache under your app data folder that you can delete at any time without losing information.

The three places PicOrg writes

1. Sidecar .xmp files (next to each photo)

For every photo you edit, PicOrg creates or updates a sibling `.xmp` file:

```
Trips\Iceland\  
  IMG_2043.jpg      ← your photo, untouched (see next section)  
  IMG_2043.xmp      ← Adobe-standard XMP sidecar written by PicOrg
```

The sidecar is a plain UTF-8 XML file you can open in any editor. It follows the Lightroom convention (strip original extension, use `.xmp`), so Lightroom, Bridge, digiKam, and darktable all read it.

2. Embedded XMP inside the source JPEG

Since v1, PicOrg also injects a standard XMP APP1 segment into the source JPEG itself so tools that ignore sidecars (Windows Explorer's Details tab, the Photos app, most viewers) still see your tags, title, rating, and comment.

- Non-JPEG formats (PNG, HEIC, RAW, TIFF, WebP) get only the sidecar in v1. This is a safe default that never touches the pixels.
- The injection is atomic: PicOrg writes a temp file next to the original and renames over it, so a crash mid-write never leaves you with a truncated photo.
- If the source file is on read-only media, PicOrg logs a warning and falls back to sidecar-only.

3. PicOrg's own cache and index

Under `%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg\`:

com.picorg.picorg\	
picorg.db	← SQLite index of every photo you've added
thumbs\	← WebP thumbnails, keyed by photo id
logs\	
picorg.log	← rolling log; useful if something misbehaves

None of this is your data — it's derived from your files and can be rebuilt at any time by rescanning. Feel free to delete the whole folder to reset PicOrg.

What PicOrg never does

- **It does not move or rename your photos.** Ever. Files stay where you put them.
- **It does not upload anything.** There is no server, no telemetry, no analytics.
- **It does not modify the pixels.** The only thing it changes in the source file is the XMP segment.
- **It does not touch photos in folders you haven't added.**

Round-trip guarantees

If tool X wrote a tag into your photo, PicOrg reads it. If PicOrg writes a tag, tool X sees it. Concretely:

Tag written by	Read back correctly in
Windows Explorer	PicOrg, Lightroom, Bridge, digiKam
PicOrg	Windows Explorer, Photos app, Lightroom, Bridge, digiKam
Adobe Lightroom sidecar	PicOrg (from sidecar), Bridge (from sidecar), digiKam
digiKam	PicOrg (both embedded and sidecar), Lightroom, Bridge

Portability

Your library is portable: copy the folder tree to another machine (with the sidecar files) and every tag, rating, title, and comment comes with it. Point a fresh PicOrg install at the folder and it re-indexes in a couple of minutes.

Interoperability with other tools

PicOrg is designed to be a **good citizen** in a mixed toolchain. It writes only industry-standard XMP, in two places (sidecar and embedded), so it plays nice with:

Windows File Explorer

- **Reads:** PicOrg tags show up in the *Details* tab (right-click a photo → Properties → Details), and in the *Tags* column when you enable it in a folder view.
- **Writes:** Tags you add through Explorer's Details tab are written as `MicrosoftPhoto:LastKeywordXMP` **inside the JPEG**. PicOrg picks those up on the next rescan (or when you next open the details panel for that photo).

Windows Photos app

- **Reads:** Titles and ratings written by PicOrg show up.
- **Writes:** Very little; ratings you set in Photos are read by PicOrg on next rescan.

Adobe Lightroom Classic

- **Sidecar path.** Lightroom writes `.xmp` sidecars using exactly the same convention PicOrg does (`Photo.CR2` → `Photo.xmp`). Both tools read each other's sidecars without a fuss.
- **Standard fields.** `xmp:Rating`, `dc:title`, `dc:description`, `dc:subject` are all interoperable.
- **Metadata sync.** If you edit metadata in Lightroom, run Metadata → *Save Metadata to File* to force a sidecar update, then Rescan in PicOrg. Or the other way around.

Adobe Bridge

Reads and writes the same XMP that Lightroom does — everything above applies unchanged.

digiKam

- **Reads embedded XMP** by default (no sidecar dependency) — PicOrg's embedded XMP writes make everything visible immediately.
- Also reads sidecars if configured to. Consistent both ways.

darktable

Reads `.xmp` sidecars natively (darktable uses sidecars for its own edit history), so PicOrg tags/ratings/titles show up alongside the darktable edits. No conflict — the two tools use non-overlapping XMP namespaces.

XnView, FastStone, IrfanView, ExifTool

All of these read standard XMP from either the sidecar or the embedded segment, so PicOrg edits are visible.

The one field that's slightly non-standard

Windows Explorer historically stores tags in a Microsoft-only field called `MicrosoftPhoto:LastKeywordXMP` in addition to standard `dc:subject`. To make sure a tag added in Explorer round-trips correctly, PicOrg **reads both** and **writes both**. Non-Microsoft tools happily ignore the extra field.

The one thing PicOrg doesn't yet do

- **RAW files (CR2, NEF, ARW, DNG, RAF, ...):** PicOrg reads their EXIF and existing sidecars, but writes only the sidecar — the RAW file itself is never modified. This is intentional: modifying RAWs in-place is risky, and Lightroom's convention is sidecar-only for RAW too.

If you need embedded XMP in a RAW to be visible in a tool that only reads embedded metadata, use PicOrg's sidecar and then run `exiftool -tagsfromfile Photo.xmp Photo.CR2` in the same folder.

Keyboard shortcuts

Selection

Shortcut	Action
Click	Select one photo
Ctrl + Click	Toggle a photo in the selection
Shift + Click	Extend selection from the last-clicked photo
Ctrl + A	Select every photo in the current filtered view
Esc	Clear selection

Navigation

Shortcut	Action
↑ / ↓ / ← / →	Move the selection cursor in the grid
Home / End	Jump to the first / last photo in the view
Page Up / Page Down	Jump one screen up / down

Metadata

Shortcut	Action
0	Clear rating (equivalent to clicking the star again)
1–5	Set rating 1..5 stars on the current selection
Tab (in title/comment)	Commit and move focus to the next field
Enter (in tag input)	Commit the current tag draft

Shortcut	Action
Space (in tag input)	Commit the current tag draft
Comma (in tag input)	Commit the current tag draft
Backspace (empty tag input)	Remove the last committed tag

Application

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + F	Focus the search box
Ctrl + R	Rescan all library folders
Delete	Move selection to Recycle Bin (with confirmation)
Shift + Delete	Permanently delete selection (with confirmation)
F1	Open the User Manual

Layout

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + B	Toggle the sidebar
Ctrl + D	Toggle the details panel
F11	Toggle full-screen

Troubleshooting

Most issues fall into one of a handful of buckets. The log at `%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg\logs\picorg.log` records what PicOrg did — open it in Notepad, scroll to the bottom, and look for `WARN` or `ERROR` lines.

The app won't start

Symptom: Double-click PicOrg, nothing happens, or a WebView2 error dialog appears.

Fix: Install the Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime. It's a free Microsoft download. Windows 11 already has it; Windows 10 usually gets it via Windows Update.

Tags I set in Windows Explorer don't show up

Symptom: You added tags in File Explorer's Details panel, but PicOrg's sidebar doesn't list them.

Cause: PicOrg reads metadata on the first scan and caches it. Explorer wrote new tags into the JPEG *after* that.

Fix: Click **Rescan** in the top bar, or right-click the folder containing the photos and choose **Rescan folder**. PicOrg detects the modified files and re-reads their metadata.

Tags I set in PicOrg don't show up in Windows Explorer

Symptom: You added a tag in PicOrg, but Explorer's *Tags* column is blank.

Diagnosis and fix — one of the following:

1. **You need to refresh Explorer's index.** Explorer caches tag listings aggressively; F5 doesn't always rebuild them. Right-click the folder → **Refresh** or navigate away and back.
2. **The file is a non-JPEG format.** PicOrg embeds tags into JPEG only in v1; for PNG/HEIC/RAW it writes a sidecar (which Explorer doesn't read). Convert to JPEG or use

the sidecar-aware tool of your choice.

3. **Read-only file or folder.** PicOrg logs a warning like `sidecar write failed`. Grant write permission to the folder and retry.
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Photos are missing from the grid

Symptom: A folder has photos on disk but PicOrg's grid shows fewer.

Possible causes:

- **Unsupported format.** PicOrg indexes JPEG, PNG, GIF, BMP, TIFF, WebP, HEIC/HEIF, and common RAW extensions (CR2, CR3, NEF, ARW, DNG, RAF, ORF, PEF, X3F). Other files are ignored.
 - **Files are hidden or system-flagged.** PicOrg skips OS-hidden files by default.
 - **A prior scan errored.** Run **Rescan folder** to retry.
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The app is slow to start / laggy scrolling

Symptom: First launch takes noticeable time, or the grid stutters.

Fix:

- The first scan of a large folder generates thumbnails on all CPU cores. Wait for the status bar to say `Idle` — subsequent launches are near-instant.
 - If scrolling is choppy, close other GPU-heavy apps; PicOrg uses WebView2 which shares the GPU.
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“Save failed” toast in multi-select

Symptom: After clicking *Apply tag changes to N images*, PicOrg shows a red *Save failed: ...* message.

Fix: Open `picorg.log` and look for the line right after `applyTags dispatch:`. It'll say specifically which image failed (usually a permission issue on the source folder). Fix the file permissions and click Apply again.

I want to reset PicOrg completely

Close the app. Delete `%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg\` . Relaunch. All your photos and sidecars are still on disk — PicOrg re-scans on the next launch.